

Photographs by MUJEEB FARUQUI

PROPERTIES TO FIGHT FOR

Some of the properties of the Bhopal royal family marked 'Enemy Property'

- **Riyaz Manzil, covering 8.39 acres**, of which less than half is owned by Sajida Sultan; the rest is under different names
- **310 hectares** in the Koh-e-Fiza area in Bhopal, of which 270 hectares are under the Upper Lake. Remaining 40 hectares have houses on it
- **6.72 hectares** in village Nayapura
- **6.14 hectares** in the name of Aftab Jahan Begum, the second wife of Hamidullah Khan
- **9.76 hectares** at village Laukhedi near Bhopal
- **Also under the scanner** are Flag Staff House, Noor-Us-Sabah palace, Dar-Us-Salam property, bungalow of Habibi and Ahmedabad palace

Source: DM office, Bhopal

BHOPAL ROYAL FAMILY



Hamidullah Khan (1894-1960)
Last Nawab of Bhopal

Abida Sultan (1913-2002)
Migrated to Pakistan in 1950, mother of Shahryar Khan, former Pakistan foreign secretary



Rabia Sultan (1916-2000)



Sajida Sultan (1915-1995) *m.* **Iftikhar Ali Khan** (1910-1952)
Nawab of Pataudi, former cricketer

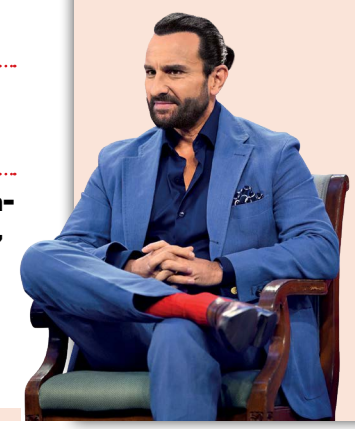
Mansur Ali Khan Pataudi (1941-2011)
Former cricketer



m.

Sharmila Tagore (1944-)
Actress





Saba Ali Khan | **Saif Ali Khan** | **Soha Ali Khan**

m.: Married to

Bollywood actor Saif Ali Khan is going through a tumultuous time. But even before the January 16 knife attack on him by an intruder at his Mumbai home, a Madhya Pradesh High Court order reignited a dispute over property pertaining to the erstwhile royal family of Bhopal, of which Saif is a prominent member. While no official estimate of the value of the royal properties that Saif and his relatives have laid claim to as inheritor has been declared, it is estimated to be over Rs 10,000 crore. Other than land in various areas, the properties under the scanner include prominent Bhopal landmarks like the Flag Staff House, the luxury hotel Noor-Us-Sabah Palace, the Dar-Us-Salam residential property, bungalow of Habibi and the Ahmedabad Palace.

So how did the case of the Bhopal royal properties land up in court? While there have been several disputes among members of the Bhopal royal family over property, in December 2014, the Custodian of Enemy Property, a Central government department based in Mumbai, sent a letter citing section 11 of the Enemy Property Act 1968—which allows the Central government to claim properties or businesses belonging to individuals who migrated to Pakistan after Partition or adopted the citizenship of China—to Saif. The Centre's legal focus lay on the migration of Abida Sultan, the eldest daughter of Hamidullah Khan, the last nawab of Bhopal, to Pakistan in 1950. Abida is the sister of Saif's grandmother, Sajida Sultan, the second daughter of the nawab, who inherited the properties after his death. Sajida married the Nawab of Pataudi, cricketer Iftikhar Ali Khan, and was the mother of the iconic Indian cricket captain